Adolf Hitler: The Larry King Interview

By Jon Stewart

KING: **(Pg 139-150)** *(Larry King Live Music*)* Good evening, ladies and gentlemen. Tonight we bring you perhaps the most controversial show in the history of Larry King Live. He began his career as president of the fledgling National Socialist party, the Nazi party, in Germany. After a failed coup, some prison time and a bestselling book, he reestablished himself in the German hierarchy, first as chancellor. . . then as Fuhrer. The next ten years under his watch saw Germany's return to power, shame at the Munich Olympics, a failed marriage and finally, one helluva World War complete with what was thought to be a cowardly demise by his own hand. Tonight, risen from the proverbial dead, we welcome Adolf Hitler.

INTRODUCTION

One of the beautiful aspects of our culture is the capacity we have to forgive, especially those in the public eye. This grand compassion was put to the ultimate challenge when in the fall of 1999 an astonished world watched as a historical figure long thought to have died in World War 2 resurfaced. This disgraced dictator, swayed by a beautifully arranged fruit basket and handwritten note, went on CNN's Larry King Live. The Hitler interview, as it became known, aired on October 23, 1999. The following is an uncensored transcript of that historic interview.

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KING: Well, Chancellor Hitler, I have-

HITLER: Please call me Adolf.

KING: Adolf. First of all, I have to say. . . quite frankly, we were very reluctant to have you on.

ITLER: I can't say I blame you for that. I mean, you hear the name Hitler ...

KING: What do you say to all the people out there, the people who view you as a demon, the perpetrator of the most vicious-

HITLER: Guilty as charged, Larry. Look, I was a bad guy. No question. I hate that Hitler. The yelling, the finger pointing, I don't know. . . I was a very angry guy.

KING: And this. . . new Hitler?

HITLER: I get up at seven, have half a melon, and do the Jumble in the morning paper. Some days I'll fish, maybe

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hit the mall for an Orange Julius. The other day I spent seven hours in the park watching ants cart off part of a sandwich. Me!! The inventor of the Blitzkrieg. . . When you stop having to control everything, it's very freeing.

KING: Why did you do it?

HITLER: Whooo boy. The $64,000 question. I don't know. . . I wasn't a happy kid. I mean, I'm not trying to make excuses, but you go through high school with the nickname S***ler I'm sorry, they can bleep that, right? After a while you get sick of it. One day you just snap. It started out as the typical "Someday you guys will be sorry," and then . . . I don't know. It just got away from me.

KING: Did you ever see the despicable nature of your actions? Was there any remorse?

HITLER: Oh sure, but denial is a powerful thing. . . I always thought I could stop any time I wanted. "If I could just get Czechoslovakia, that'll be the end of it. I'll be happy then." And I'd get it and think, well geez, Poland's just up the road a piece and. . . you know the rest. I think admitting to myself that there was a problem was the toughest part.

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KING: And when was that?

HITLER: Well. . . I'm not going to lie to you, it took a while. There were moments all along where I knew something was wrong. I remember one time. . . I think it was in Munich in 1942. We were having a rally. 100,000 people all chanting my name. The bonfires were going. The whole shebang. It should've been a crowning moment but I clearly remember thinking, What am I doing here? I hate crowds. But I didn't hit rock bottom until, as you know, 1945.

KING: Yes, tell us about those final days in the Berlin bunker, where, until now, we had assumed you had killed yourself.

HITLER: *(takes a sip of water)* Right, well. Funny story. Everyone thought I went into the bunker to escape . . . [but] No. Actually, as the Allied Forces were closing in I was still in denial. I really thought we were gonna rally, you know, make an end run around Switzerland and flank 'em. So I'm planning furiously and snapping at people-as my therapist says, "playing the dictator." So Eva calls me down to the bunker for some "emergency" with the generators. Anyway, I go down and there's Eva and

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Himmler and two of my other closest friends. I'll never forget. I walk in and Eva takes my face in her hands, looks me in the eyes and says "Adolf, we all love you very much, but if you don't stop with this conquer and purify thing, no one in this room will ever talk to you again."

KING: And that snapped you out of it?

HITLER: Not quite. You have to understand I'd been running with this thing for about fifteen years at that point. *(beat, then nonchalantly)* I shot them. Back then we didn't know [about] interventions. I just figured they were betraying me. Anyway, I threw on Eva's clothes and snuck out into the night. I lived like an animal for weeks, doing what I had to do to get by. One day a group of boys were making fun of the lady with the mustache, and I got a look at myself in the reflection of a window and realized they were talking about me. It was then I knew I had to get my life together.

KING: Interesting. Now tell me about your relationship with Eva. She was a beautiful woman. Do you think she was mesmerized by your power?

HITLER: Well, all I can say is *(breaks into a broad smile)* Look, Larry. I learned long ago that Bavarian art majors

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with oily hair and weasely mustaches weren't getting the ladies. Of course, that was the only reason Eva went out with me. Women love power and fame.

KING: *(changing the subject)* Scientists recently cloned a sheep . . . Dolly I believe was her name. You've always had an interest in things genetic. Your take on this scientific breakthrough?

HITLER: Well, Larry, "transgenics," as that branch of genetic research is known, is an exciting specialty, and the Roslin project, the sheep cloning, is an exciting advance. But I certainly wouldn't qualify it as a breakthrough.

KING: You must admit there are real ethical questions that go along with the cloning of humans.

HITLER: Well, Larry, the big fear here is that some evil guy gets a hold of this stuff and makes another me. *(beat, shaking his head)* People will never be cloned. Superficially perhaps, but personality, character, even intelligence cannot be genetically duplicated. Only tendencies. I'm a big environment convert. Nurture over nature. You could duplicate my genes, but you wouldn't get me unless you duplicate my upbringing. You'd have to get some older children to tease this new Hitler

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mercilessly, giving him constant wedgies . . . *(Hitler begins to cry.)* Excuse me, I believe some dust is in my contacts. *(Hitler wipes his eyes.)*

KING: Was the Third Reich working on cloning?

HITLER: *(sips some water)* Oh, sure, we gave it a shot. We created some chickens that vaguely resembled each other. And one of our top guys cloned a replica of your heroic dog Lassie-but after some checking, we found out it was just a reassembled Corgi. All involved were put to sleep. Our guys just weren't up to the task.

KING: You had certainly made science a priority . . .

HITLER: Which brings up an interesting irony. Here I was, a guy with a plan to create a master race, dominate the world by blending brute force with cutting-edge technology. So what do I do? I deport or kill all my best scientists. The Jews were some of my best technical people. It's classic fear of success. I create something, then sabotage its chances of ever actually working. It's a pattern I've repeated over and over again. I'm defeating all challengers on the Western front, couple more weeks, I got the whole thing sewn up. So what do I do? Attack Russia?!! *(Hitler taps his finger on his temple.)* Way to go, genius!!

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KING: But you got away with it. After all these years, why resurface?

HITLER: My therapist challenged me to put up or shut up. To prove to myself that I could take responsibility for my life. So here I am.

KING: *(holding up a book)* We've been talking with Adolf Hitler, the book is-

HITLER: . . . The book is called Mein Comfortable Shoes-get it? It's about an angry man who learns to appreciate the little things in life. It's about acceptance.

KING: And it's a terrific read. Folks, if you read no other book this summer, make it Mein Comfortable Shoes. What's next for Adolf Hitler?

HITLER: I'll be doing Politically Incorrect next Thursday, and as always you can see my old work on the A&E network. And in two weeks, I'll be appearing on Court TV as I stand trial for crimes against humanity.

KING: Right, that is coming up. What kind of defense will you be offering?

HITLER: Not much. I fully expect that by this time next year, I'll have been convicted and possibly put to death. I'm

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going to represent myself, though. From now on the blame goes here *(pointing to chest).* The only one to blame for Hitler . . . is Hitler. Besides, who wants to get involved with a bunch of phony-baloney defense lawyers. . . I mean, talk about evil. *(Both laugh.)*

KING: Well, Adolf, thanks for coming by.

HITLER: Thank you.

CLOSING

KING: *Stay tuned next week when we get up close and personal with another "man-about-town" -- Former President Donald Trump!* *(Larry King Live Music*)*

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Jon Stewart
Book: Naked Pictures of Famous People (Pg 139-150)
ISBN: 978-0688155308
Publisher: Harper Collins
Date (Month/Year): Oct 1999

AWARD HISTORY

2002 National Qualifier

Larry King Live Intro Music can be found here:
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HHGObH_04Ng

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